

EGYPT

JANUARY 2015 – JULY 2026

Prepared by Africa INSIGHTS Research Team | Vertical: Travel & Tourism

Egypt's perception score has fallen to its lowest point in the study window, driven by worsening hospitality and transport sentiment that now overshadow its unrivalled scenery.

2,305	59%	18%	23%	64/100
RECORDS IN VIEW	POSITIVE	NEUTRAL	NEGATIVE	PERCEPTION

01 MONTH IN REVIEW

Egypt's travel perception has deteriorated sharply over the study window, reaching a **perception score of 51** in 2026 — the lowest recorded across the entire January 2015 – July 2026 period and a **21-point decline from the 2017 peak of 76**. The acceleration is not gradual drift: negativity in the most recent year stands at **36.2%**, more than double the **10.2%** recorded in 2017. Two themes are doing the most damage — hospitality and transport — and both are worsening faster in the second half of the period than in the first. The destination's extraordinary scenery continues to draw visitors and generate enthusiasm, but it is no longer sufficient to carry overall perception on its own.

The single most important signal for decision-makers is the hospitality trajectory. Negative hospitality sentiment rose by **26.3 points** between the first and second halves of the period, making it the largest reportable shift in the data. Visitor voices make the mechanism clear: scams, harassment, and informal demands for money are turning first-time visitors into active detractors. @sunnycasillas179 (Oct 2023) described Egypt as "not tourist friendly at all" and cited airport employees "asking for money in every co[rridor]" — a complaint that resonates across the data and directly suppresses repeat-visit intent.

The single action the director should take this quarter is to commission a targeted intervention on the ground-level hospitality experience — particularly at transport hubs and heritage sites — and pair it with a transparent public communication campaign that shows what is being done. Without that, the perception score will continue to fall even as marketing spend on scenery messaging delivers diminishing returns.

DATA NOTE

The period label spans January 2015 to July 2026 but trend data are reported at annual granularity; the 2026 figure therefore reflects only the months available to the cut-off date and is not a full-year observation.

DATA NOTE

The data source is overwhelmingly YouTube comments (99.9% of records), which captures a self-selecting, digitally active audience. Perceptions held by offline or non-English-speaking traveller segments are not represented.

02 PERCEPTION OVERVIEW

Egypt scores **64 out of 100** on the perception scale for the full period — sitting above the neutral midpoint of 50 but meaningfully below what the destination's heritage assets might suggest is achievable. **Net sentiment stands at 36.3**, derived from **59.3% positive**, **17.6% neutral**, and **23.1% negative** records across a sample of **2,305**. The positive majority confirms that Egypt retains genuine affection among a large share of visitors and observers, but the negative share — more than one in five records — is high enough to be an active drag on word-of-mouth.

The sentiment mix tells a story about structural tension rather than uniform satisfaction. The **17.6% neutral share** is notable: a destination that strongly polarises visitors tends to produce fewer neutrals as people are pushed to either enthusiasm or frustration. Egypt's neutral share suggests a middle cohort that engaged but came away without a strong recommendation to make — visitors who experienced enough friction to dampen enthusiasm without experiencing outright disaster. That is an opportunity: converting neutral sentiment to positive requires operational fixes more than marketing spend.

The overall period score of 64 also obscures a worsening trajectory. The annual perception score was **72 in 2015**, peaked at **76 in 2017**, and has since declined, closing at **51 in 2026**. A score of 51 is only marginally above the neutral threshold and signals that Egypt is within reach of a negative-majority perception environment if the current trend continues. The urgency for intervention is real.

DATA NOTE

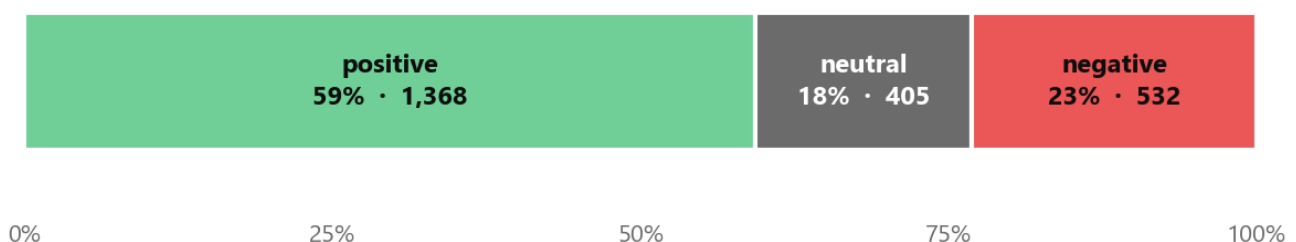
The 2026 perception score of 51 is based on records collected up to July 2026 only and may shift as the year completes.

DATA NOTE

Period-level figures (score of 64, net sentiment of 36.3) aggregate across all years and therefore blend the stronger early-period performance with the weaker recent performance; they should not be used to characterise current conditions without reference to the annual trend.

Figure 1 — Sentiment breakdown

How the 2,305 records in view split across sentiment classes. Net sentiment is +36 points.



03 THEMATIC ANALYSIS

Scenery is Egypt's strongest and most durable asset. With **224 mentions** and a **net sentiment of 68.8** — the highest positive net of any reportable theme — the Pyramids, temples, and Nile landscapes generate reliable enthusiasm. The sentiment is not just passive appreciation: voices reach for superlatives, and the data show an excitement emotion share of **16.8%** across the corpus, largely traceable to heritage content. Even critics frequently concede the physical spectacle, as @MaatKemmet-e4n (May 2025) illustrated in the pithy formulation "Very expensive — that's right fellas she's gorgeous," acknowledging cost frustration while affirming the draw. Scenery's negative share has edged up by **7.3 points** between the two halves of the period — a reportable worsening — suggesting that over-crowding, site-management issues, or commercialisation at heritage locations are beginning to dilute the experience even here.

Hospitality is the most urgent crisis theme. It receives the most mentions of any theme — **238** — and its net sentiment is barely positive at **2.1**, masking a near-even split of **47.5% positive** against **45.4% negative**. More critically, negative hospitality sentiment worsened by **26.3 points** across the two halves of the period: from **31.9%** in the first half to **58.2%** in the second. This is the largest reportable shift in the entire dataset. The guest experience described by @RALIF.ISMAIL (Aug 2022) — "don't go to egypt... it's really not worth the scams and harassments" — and by @capt2be (Feb 2024), who noted that even diplomatic passport holders "dealt with the same crap," captures a systemic rather than incidental problem. When someone with embassy credentials reports the same friction as a first-time leisure traveller, the issue is structural. Tourism boards cannot out-market a broken on-the-ground experience.

Transport compounds the hospitality problem and may be equally consequential for overall scores. With **114 mentions**, a **net sentiment of -29.8**, and a **55.3% negative share**, transport is the second-most-criticised reportable theme. Its negative rate worsened by **14.8 points** between the two halves. @sunnycasillas179 (Oct 2023) singled out the airport — transport's first and last impression — as the final breaking point of an already-strained visit. Cost perception is also materially negative: a **net of -28.8** across **52 mentions**, with exactly **50% negative**, and notably no improvement across time — it is the only reportable theme showing zero change between halves. Food sits in a more constructive position, with a **net of 30.4** and a slight improvement in the second half, suggesting culinary experience is an underutilised positive message. Housing, with a **net of 20.0**, has deteriorated by **20.2 points** in negativity across the period and warrants monitoring even as it remains net-positive.

DATA NOTE

Electricity and wildlife fall below the 15-mention threshold and are excluded from headline findings. Both show negative-majority sentiment in the available data and are noted as indicative only.

DATA NOTE

The food theme's second-half improvement is based on a move from 53 mentions to 26 mentions (first to second half), meaning the improvement rests on a larger recent sample — directionally encouraging but not yet a firm trend reversal.

Voices behind the numbers

The most-engaged supportive and critical mentions in this view. Emoji and non-Latin characters are stripped for print.

POSITIVE · @KernelBeans · Oct 2021 · 9,635 likes · score +0.39

"Man, the Egyptians would have really enjoyed Minecraft."

POSITIVE · @-l9p · Dec 2018 · 4,791 likes · score +0.77

" "

NEGATIVE · @RALIF.ISMAIL · Aug 2022 · 15,005 likes · score -0.45

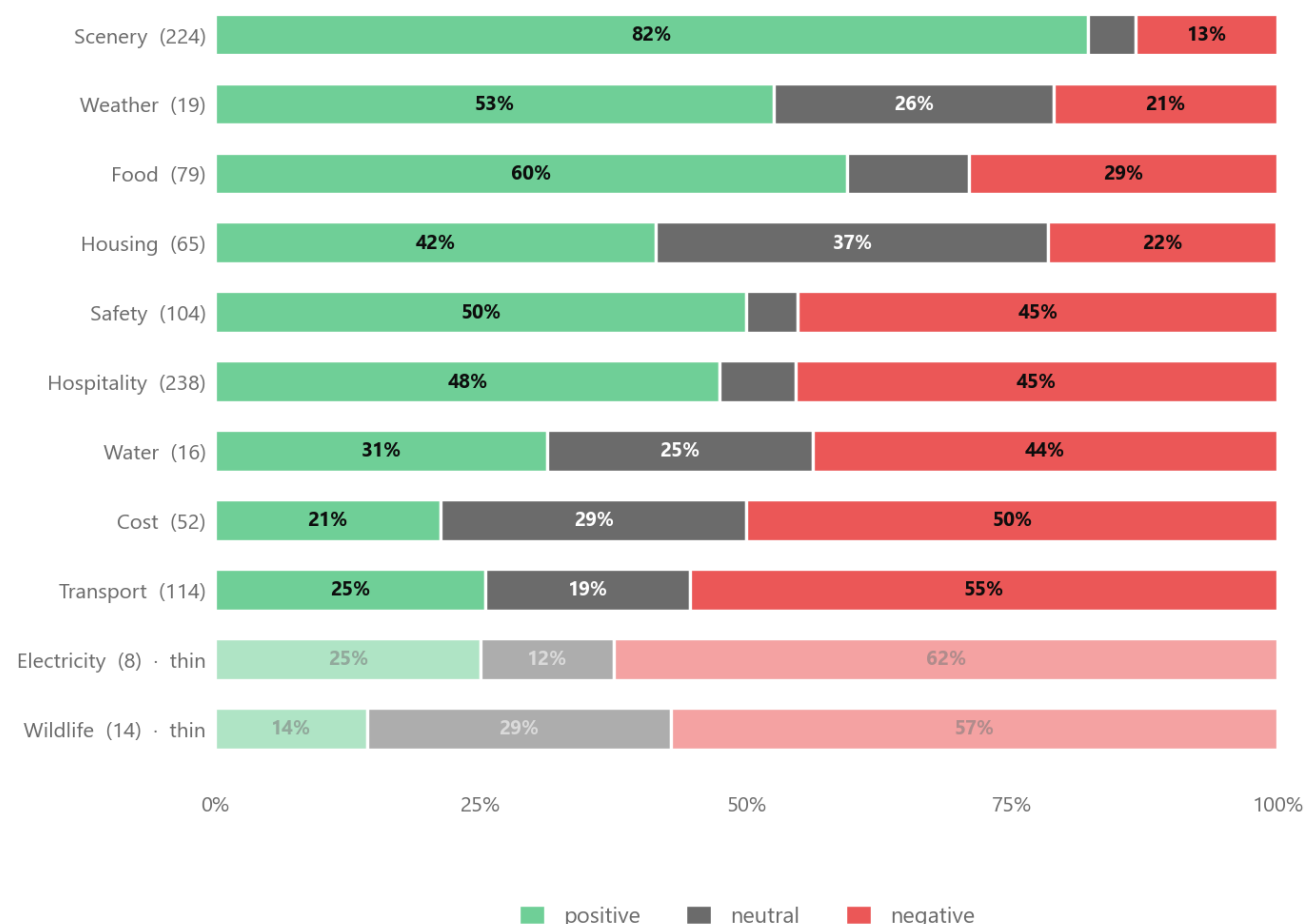
"i was just there last month. i didn't believe when youtubers say "don't go to egypt" but after my visit, i fully believe it 200%. Pyramids are nice but honestly, it's really not worth the scams and harrasments."

NEGATIVE · @capt2be · Feb 2024 · 8,777 likes · score -0.87

"Worked at the US Embassy in Cairo for 2 years. I had a diplomatic passport (Vienna Convention..."you can't look in my bags") and STILL dealt with the same crap. Cairo has a near zero percent repeat tourism rate for a reason."

Figure 2 — Sentiment by theme

Every travel theme mentioned in this view, ranked by net sentiment. Mention counts in brackets; themes below the 15-mention floor are faded and marked thin.



04 VISITOR SEGMENTS

The segment classification rate for this dataset is **5.0%**, meaning **2,190 of 2,305 records** could not be assigned to a named visitor cohort. No individual cohort — adventure, business, budget, or luxury — clears the 50-record minimum required for reportable findings. The directions visible in the sub-threshold data are noted here as indicative context only, and no cohort should be ranked against another or used to anchor a recommendation.

What the indicative picture suggests — without asserting it as a finding — is that business sentiment appears substantially more negative than leisure-oriented segments, and that luxury visitors appear to be generating a higher negative share than budget visitors. If confirmed by a larger classified sample, this would be strategically significant: luxury travellers tend to be higher-yield and louder word-of-mouth generators, and a destination that fails to satisfy them pays a disproportionate reputational cost. The tourism board should prioritise improving segment classification in future data collection so that cohort-level targeting decisions can rest on reportable evidence.

DATA NOTE

No visitor cohort clears the 50-record minimum threshold. All four cohorts (adventure, business, budget, luxury) are non-reportable. Figures for individual cohorts are present in the underlying data but cannot be used to headline findings or support comparative claims.

DATA NOTE

Only 5.0% of records were classifiable to a segment. Any cohort-level insight should be treated as exploratory until a richer classified sample is available.

VISITOR SEGMENT	RECORDS	SHARE OF VIEW	PERCEPTION	NET
Adventure · thin	39	1.7%	63/100	+41
Business · thin	32	1.4%	30/100	-53
Budget · thin	27	1.2%	56/100	+15
Luxury · thin	17	0.7%	46/100	-18

05 COMPETITIVE BENCHMARKING

Egypt ranks **8th out of 10** in the peer group, with a perception score of **64** against a group leader, Tanzania, at **73** — a gap of **9 points**. The peer set also includes Ghana, Rwanda, and Senegal, each at **70**, and Kenya at **69**. Zimbabwe at **68** and South Africa at **65** sit immediately above Egypt; only Nigeria at **62** and Morocco at **39** score lower among reportable peers. Egypt's positive share of **59.3%** matches South Africa exactly but sits well behind Tanzania's **70.8%**, while Egypt's negative share of **23.1%** is higher than every peer except Morocco. The pattern confirms that Egypt is not simply trailing on positives — it is generating more detractors than comparable destinations.

The theme-level gaps clarify where the competitive disadvantage is concentrated. The largest reportable gap is in transport, where Egypt's net of **-29.8** compares to a peer average net of **7.7** — a gap of **37.5 points**. That is not a marginal underperformance; it is a category-defining weakness that peers are not sharing. Hospitality shows a **26.1-point gap** against peers (Egypt net **2.1** versus peer net **28.2**), and cost perception trails by **16.5 points** (Egypt net **-28.8** versus peer net **-12.3**). Water access carries a **15.1-point gap** and food a **12.5-point gap**, both in the same direction. Taken together, these gaps paint a consistent picture: Egypt's operational and service dimensions are underperforming relative to its regional peers in ways that are large enough to explain the overall ranking gap.

The one reportable area where Egypt holds an advantage over peers is safety, where Egypt's net of **4.8** compares to a peer average net of **-5.7** — a gap of **10.5 points** in Egypt's favour. This is counter-intuitive given the safety theme's own worsening trend within the Egypt data, and it suggests that several peer destinations carry heavier safety burdens still. Egypt should treat this advantage as fragile rather than durable: safety's negative share has risen by **19.5 points** between the two halves of the period, and the peer advantage could narrow quickly if that trend continues.

DATA NOTE

Cameroon is excluded from comparative findings as its 16-record sample falls below the reportable threshold.

DATA NOTE

The scenery, weather, and housing aspect gaps versus peers are below the 10-point gap threshold and are therefore not stated as competitive gaps in this section.

DATA NOTE

Peer net sentiment figures are averages across the named peer group and are drawn directly from the fact pack; they are not calculated by this report.

MARKET	RECORDS	PERCEPTION	NET SENTIMENT
Tanzania	1,326	73/100	+59
Ghana	1,094	70/100	+52
Rwanda	1,526	70/100	+54
Senegal	1,114	70/100	+50
Kenya	2,075	69/100	+52
Zimbabwe	1,186	68/100	+50
South Africa	2,164	65/100	+39
Egypt	2,305	64/100	+36
Nigeria	1,884	62/100	+33
Morocco	52	39/100	-21

06 TRENDS & SIGNALS

The overarching trend is an **unambiguous and accelerating decline**. Egypt's perception score fell from **72 in 2015** to **51 in 2026**, a **21-point drop** over the window. The fall has not been linear: a peak of **76 in 2017** was followed by a sharp correction to **61 in 2018**, a partial recovery to **72 in 2021**, and then a steeper and more sustained decline through **61 in 2023**, **59 in 2025**, and **51 in 2026**. The 2026 figure — recorded on the highest annual volume of the entire period at **373 records** — is not a thin-sample anomaly. It represents the most evidence-rich and most negative reading in the dataset simultaneously, which makes it the most reliable signal of where perception currently stands.

Hospitality and transport are the signal themes — both worsening at a pace that comfortably exceeds the trend threshold and both doing so on reportable sample sizes. Hospitality's negative share moved from **31.9%** to **58.2%**, a **26.3-point** shift. Transport moved from **47.1%** to **61.9%**, a **14.8-point** shift. Housing has also worsened by a reportable **20.2 points** and warrants elevation from a monitoring concern to an active management issue. Safety's deterioration of **19.5 points** is reportable and significant given that safety commands the

second-highest mention volume among worsening themes.

Against this, two themes offer a degree of stability or relief. Food sentiment is effectively stable — negative share moved only **-2.5 points**, within the noise band — and the direction is marginally improving, giving the culinary experience a credibility that transport and hospitality currently lack. Scenery, despite its **7.3-point** worsening in negativity, retains the highest net sentiment of any theme and continues to drive the excitement emotions that represent Egypt's most powerful marketing raw material. The strategic challenge is to protect that asset while simultaneously repairing the service dimensions that are converting excited arrivals into disappointed detractors.

DATA NOTE

Annual perception scores for 2015 (24 records) and 2016 (56 records) are close to or at the minimum sample threshold and should be treated with slightly more caution than later years, though 2016 clears the 50-record floor.

DATA NOTE

The 2026 data cover only January through July; the perception score of 51 and negative share of 36.2% reflect a partial year and could shift before the year closes.

Figure 3 — Perception over time (by year)

Perception score per period on a 0–100 scale, where 50 is neutral.

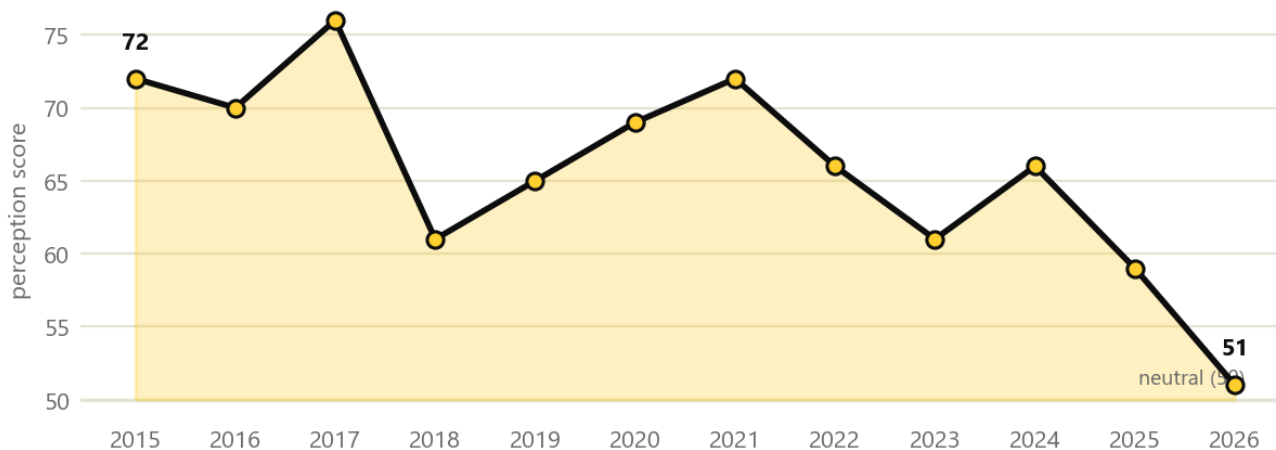
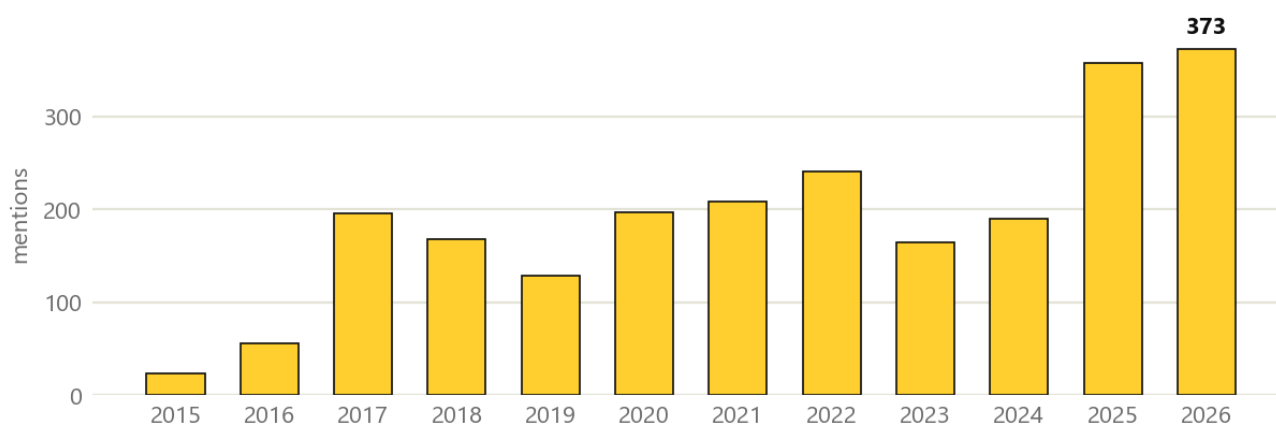


Figure 4 — Conversation volume (by year)

Records per period. Read the trend above against this: a swing on thin volume is noise.



07 RECOMMENDATIONS

The hospitality crisis is the first and most urgent priority. The **26.3-point worsening in hospitality negativity** — the largest reportable shift in the dataset — combined with the **26.1-point gap behind peers** on the same theme means that no marketing effort will be efficient while visitors are leaving as detractors. The tourism board should work with the Ministry of Tourism and the Egyptian Tourism Authority to launch a structured, measurable anti-harassment and fair-pricing programme at the highest-friction touchpoints: the Giza plateau, Luxor temple precincts, and the major cruise embarkation points. Progress metrics — complaint volumes, mystery-shopper scores, repeat-visit intent — should be published quarterly so that improvement is visible and credible, not just claimed.

Transport is the second operational repair that must precede messaging investment. Egypt's transport net of **-29.8** against a peer net of **+7.7** — a **37.5-point gap**, the widest in the benchmarking — tells the board that this is not a matter of traveller expectation management but of tangible service quality. The airport experience in particular is repeatedly cited as a point of breakdown: informal money demands described by @sunnycasillas179 (Oct 2023) and corroborated across the corpus are a systemic integrity problem, not an isolated incident. The board should engage airport operators and ground-transport providers with a formal passenger-rights charter, staff it with visible tourism police presence at critical handover points, and make the charter a standard element of pre-trip visitor briefings.

Scenery's deteriorating edge — a **7.3-point increase in negativity** in the second half of the period — signals that even Egypt's strongest asset is at risk from site-management failures. The board should commission a visitor-experience audit at the three highest-volume heritage sites, with specific attention to crowd management, vendor licensing, and the physical condition of access infrastructure. The goal is to ensure that the scenery-led excitement that currently drives **16.8%** of records to an excited emotion is not eroded by the same operational frictions degrading hospitality scores.

Finally, the **10.5-point safety advantage over peers** is a competitive differentiator that Egypt is not exploiting in its destination marketing, and it is fragile: safety negativity worsened by a reportable **19.5 points** within the period. The board's international communications team — particularly those targeting the North American and European source markets visible in the YouTube corpus — should foreground safety credentials in a fact-based, specific way (citing statistics, visible policing, traveller-insurance partnerships) rather than in the broad reassurance language that sophisticated travellers discount. Simultaneously, the board must monitor safety sentiment on a quarterly basis; if the worsening trend continues, the advantage over peers will disappear and the communication strategy will need to pivot accordingly.

DATA NOTE

Segment-specific recommendations (e.g., targeting luxury or business travellers separately) cannot be made with confidence because no visitor cohort clears the 50-record reportable threshold. Recommendations are therefore directed at the general inbound visitor population.

DATA NOTE

The recommendation to exploit the safety advantage is time-sensitive: the safety trend is worsening within the Egypt data even while Egypt leads peers. The board should re-evaluate this positioning at each quarterly review.

08 METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Country	Egypt
Year range	2015–2026

Aspect (any of)	all aspects
Sentiment	positive, neutral, negative
Data source	all
Relevant records only	yes
Period	January 2015 – July 2026
Records	2,305
Generated	19 Aug 2026 12:21 UTC
Narrative	Written by claude-sonnet-4-6; every figure verified against the computed data.

Evidence base: 2,303 YouTube comments, 2 YouTube transcript segments. 97% of records were attributed to this market from what the text itself is about rather than from the query that surfaced them. Sentiment is scored by a multilingual transformer; themes, emotion and visitor segment are rule-based taggers. Evidence thresholds: 50 records for a reliable view, 15 mentions before a theme can headline a finding, 5 points before a theme counts as praised or criticised, 10 points before a cross-country gap is stated. Every figure in this report is computed from the filtered records by the analysis pipeline. The written analysis interprets those figures; each number it states is verified back against them before publication, and any section that fails verification is replaced by the deterministic summary.